



Unipart Server and Application Virtualisation

As PMO Manager supporting Unipart's enterprise technology transformation, I oversaw the Server and Application Virtualisation Programme, designed to modernise datacentre operations, optimise resource utilisation, and enhance application delivery across the organisation's global infrastructure.

Programme Overview

The programme aimed to consolidate Unipart's physical server estate and streamline application deployment through virtualisation and centralised management.

Objectives

Five strategic workstreams formed the backbone of the virtualisation programme, each targeting a distinct layer of the enterprise technology stack.

- Physical-to-Virtual Migration (P2V)
Migrate legacy datacentre servers to virtualised platforms
- Hyper-V & VMware
Implement server virtualisation across Windows and cross-platform environments
- App-V Deployment
Deploy dynamic application streaming and isolation
- Citrix Presentation Server
Integrate centralised application access for the organisation
- NetScaler
Configure secure load balancing and remote connectivity

Technical Implementation

Hyper-V & VMware Virtualisation

Hyper-V Clusters

Designed and deployed Hyper-V clusters for Windows-based workloads across the enterprise datacentre estate

VMware ESXi

Integrated VMware ESXi environments to ensure cross-platform compatibility and workload flexibility

High Availability

Established high-availability configurations and failover clustering to maximise uptime and resilience

P2V Migrations

Delivered physical-to-virtual migrations for legacy datacentre servers, retiring ageing hardware

Application & Network Solutions

App-V & Citrix Presentation Server

Virtual Application Packaging

Implemented Microsoft App-V for virtual application packaging and delivery across the organisation

Lifecycle Management

Streamlined application lifecycle management and patching processes

Centralised Access

Deployed Citrix Presentation Server for secure, centralised application access

NetScaler Integration

Secure Remote Access

Configured NetScaler gateways for secure remote access and load balancing

Performance Optimisation

Improved application performance and network efficiency across virtual environments

SSL Offloading

Enabled SSL offloading and traffic optimisation across virtual environments

Governance & Assurance

I established PMO governance to ensure delivery discipline, risk control, and alignment with Unipart's IT strategy.



Programme Planning

Programme planning and milestone tracking to maintain delivery momentum and schedule integrity



SLA Management

SLA management and performance reporting to senior IT leadership and programme stakeholders



Vendor Coordination

Vendor coordination and technical assurance across Microsoft, Citrix, and VMware partnerships



Risk & Issue Management

Risk, issue, and dependency management across all virtualisation streams throughout delivery

Stakeholder & Team Management

I led cross-functional teams comprising infrastructure engineers, application specialists, and project managers, ensuring seamless collaboration across technology domains.



Infrastructure & Operations

Infrastructure and operations teams

Application Owners

Application owners and business units

Vendor Partners

Microsoft, Citrix, and VMware

Senior IT Leadership

Executive sponsors and IT leadership

Outcomes & Benefits



-  **Successful Migration**
Successful migration of datacentre servers to virtualised platforms
-  **Unified Management**
Unified management of server and application environments across the estate
-  **Enhanced Resilience**
Enhanced scalability, resilience, and performance across all workloads
-  **Cost Reduction**
Reduced operational costs and hardware dependency through consolidation
-  **Improved User Experience**
Improved user experience through Citrix and App-V delivery models

Strategic Impact

The programme delivered a modern, virtualised infrastructure that positioned Unipart for future cloud adoption and digital transformation.

By integrating Hyper-V, VMware, App-V, Citrix, and NetScaler technologies, the organisation achieved a robust, flexible, and secure foundation for enterprise operations.

Cloud-Ready Infrastructure

A virtualised estate primed for seamless migration to cloud platforms

Technology Integration

Five enterprise technologies unified into a coherent, manageable architecture

Digital Foundation

A robust, flexible, and secure foundation enabling Unipart's ongoing digital transformation